

DSC234 AI Literacy — Week 9 Student Handout

Using Affect Recognition to Establish Good Research Habits
Sessions One & Two

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 0 — Before You Begin (completed on Brightspace before Session One)

Before engaging with today's document, write two sentences about what you expect from a piece of research written by an AI. What assumptions are you bringing to it? Record your response here so you can return to it at the end of Session Two.

Your two sentences:

SESSION ONE

Task 1 — Read the Document (20 minutes)

Your instructor will distribute the document *Focus on Affect Recognition Technology*. Eight students will read sections aloud to the group. While listening and reading, use the space below to note anything that strikes you, anything you want to question, and anything you plan to investigate in Tasks 2 and 3.

Notes while reading:

Task 2 — Company Research (15 minutes)

Choose **two companies or research architectures** mentioned in the document. Find their websites, locate the About section, and answer the four questions below for each company.

Company 1: _____ URL: _____

Q1: Is the company for-profit?

Q2: How is the company profiting from the technology?

Q3: Does the company make any statements about protecting public privacy?

Q4: Is the technology being used without informed consent? (Note: fine print buried in lengthy consent disclosures does not constitute informed consent.)

Company 2: _____ **URL:**

Q1: Is the company for-profit?

Q2: How is the company profiting from the technology?

Q3: Does the company make any statements about protecting public privacy?

Q4: Is the technology being used without informed consent? (Note: fine print buried in lengthy consent disclosures does not constitute informed consent.)

Task 3 — Source Analysis (25 minutes)

Choose **two sources** cited in the document — any type of source qualifies. Follow the links provided and complete the analysis below for each source.

Source 1: _____ **URL:**

Who wrote the article or source?

What was the author's stated purpose? If no purpose was stated, was one implied? If so, what was it?

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Did you fact-check any claims? Did the authors use their own data, or cite data from elsewhere? Where did that data come from, and how was it collected?

What were the main points of the source?

Did you uncover any potential bias? (e.g., was the author affiliated with a company that benefits from their conclusions?)

What assumptions did the author make? Is there reason to question any of them?

Bias rating: circle one — 1 (highly biased / unsupported assumptions) 2 3 4 5 (low bias / well-supported)

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Source 2: _____ **URL:**

Who wrote the article or source?

What was the author's stated purpose? If no purpose was stated, was one implied? If so, what was it?

Did you fact-check any claims? Did the authors use their own data, or cite data from elsewhere? Where did that data come from, and how was it collected?

What were the main points of the source?

Did you uncover any potential bias? (e.g., was the author affiliated with a company that benefits from their conclusions?)

What assumptions did the author make? Is there reason to question any of them?

Bias rating: circle one — 1 (highly biased / unsupported assumptions) 2 3 4 5 (low bias / well-supported)

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Reflection on Tasks 2 and 3 (10 minutes)

Complete these four reflection prompts individually before the end of Session One.

SESSION TWO

Session Two opens with a Jeopardy-style debrief of your Session One findings. The question list appears at the end of this handout for reference.

Task 4 — Critical Engagement with the Document (15 minutes)

Drawing on everything you have read and investigated across both sessions, identify the following three things from the Claude-authored document. Be specific — name the claim directly.

One claim you **accept** —

What evidence, reasoning, or corroborating source supports your acceptance of this claim?

One claim you **question or disagree with** —

What specifically gives you pause? Is it the evidence cited, the framing, the source, or the logic of the argument?

One claim you **want to investigate further** —

What would you need to find out to be more confident? Where would you look?

Task 5 — Crawford and the Claude-Authored Document (25 minutes)

Return to Chapter 5 of *Atlas of AI*. Identify specific passages or arguments Crawford makes that correspond to each of the three sections in the document. Then answer the questions below.

Identify a passage or argument from Crawford that corresponds to **Section 1** of the document (Latest Updates, Trends, and Thoughts). Does the document represent Crawford's argument accurately, or does it simplify, extend, or depart from it?

Identify a passage or argument from Crawford that corresponds to **Section 2** of the document (Impact on Marginalized Groups). Does the document represent Crawford's argument accurately, or does it simplify, extend, or depart from it?

Identify a passage or argument from Crawford that corresponds to **Section 3** of the document (Follow the Money). Does the document represent Crawford's argument accurately, or does it simplify, extend, or depart from it?

Did you discover any statements drawn from Crawford that appear to be **exaggerated, obscured, or paraphrased in a way that changes or softens their original meaning?**

Consider this carefully: **How would Claude know what Crawford actually says?** Crawford's book is a copyrighted text. Claude cannot quote it directly — it can only work from patterns in the text it was trained on, which may or may not accurately represent Crawford's precise arguments. What does this mean for how you should read any AI-generated document that claims to represent the ideas of a living author? What are the implications for research, attribution, and intellectual honesty?

Closing — Return to Task 0 (end of Session Two)

Re-read the two sentences you wrote in Task 0 before Session One. Then respond below.

Would you write those same sentences now? What changed, and why?

Appendix — Session Two Jeopardy Questions

These are the 15 questions from the Jeopardy-style debrief board, listed here for reference. Your instructor will select questions during the discussion.

Company Watch

1. You looked at a company's About page. What did it tell you — and what do you think it was designed not to tell you?
2. Did either company you researched make explicit claims about informed consent or privacy? Do you find those claims convincing? Why or why not?
3. Based on what you found, who do you think this company's technology is primarily serving — the public, or its clients? What evidence supports that?

Source Check

1. What was the single biggest signal of potential bias you found in one of your sources? What made it stand out?
2. Did the authors of your source use their own original data, or did they rely on data from elsewhere? Does that change how much weight you give to their conclusions?
3. You rated your sources on a 1–5 bias scale. Would you rate the AI-generated document on the same scale? What score would you give it, and why?

Trust the Machine?

1. After Tasks 2 and 3, is there a specific claim in the Claude document that you now trust less than you did when you first read it? What changed your mind?
2. The document was written by an AI that cannot directly quote copyrighted sources. What does that mean for how you should read any AI-generated document that claims to represent an author's ideas?
3. The document cites its own limitations — a retracted paper was removed, figures were corrected. Does that transparency make you trust it more, or does it raise more questions than it answers?

Crawford Says

1. What is one argument Crawford makes in Chapter 5 that you think the Claude document captured well? What makes you confident it's accurate?
2. What is one argument Crawford makes that you think the Claude document softened, simplified, or missed entirely?
3. Crawford wrote this book in 2021. Based on what you researched in Tasks 2 and 3, is her argument more or less relevant in 2026 than when she wrote it?

Explain This

1. So far, what is the most unsettling thing you learned or discovered — and why does it unsettle you?
2. If you had to explain to a family member why affect recognition technology matters to them personally, what would you say?
3. Has anything in this lesson provided you with useful insight in your course final project?